

Oyster Lease Expansion - Project Narrative (DRAFT)

Bayshore Sustainable Aquaculture | Prepared for TPWD review | DRAFT - not for submission without sign-off

DRAFT working narrative. Outbound filing to TPWD requires explicit owner sign-off before sending.

1. Applicant and operation

Bayshore Sustainable Aquaculture, LLC operates a recirculating shrimp system and a rack-and-bag Eastern oyster lease on a two-acre waterfront site at Clear Lake Shores. The operation is owner-run by Anthony Cross (operations) and Derek Patterson (science and R&D;), with one full-time hand. The applicant holds the current lease in good standing and seeks a measured expansion of permitted rack area.

2. Expansion request

- Add approximately 0.4 acre of rack-and-bag area adjacent to the existing footprint, within the same tidal cell.
- Increase permitted bag count in step with demonstrated survival and demand from restaurant accounts.
- No change to gear type, no bottom dredging, no new shoreline structures.

3. Environmental considerations

The proposed area sits over soft bottom already characterized in the original lease survey. Rack-and-bag culture keeps stock off the bottom, reduces siltation impact, and the bags provide structured habitat. The applicant will maintain the existing setback from the marked navigation channel and continue the seasonal desiccation schedule that controls fouling without chemical treatment.

4. Navigation and use conflicts

The expansion stays inside the leased cell and clear of the charted channel. Gear will carry the required corner markers and lighting. No conflict with existing recreational or commercial traffic is anticipated.

5. Monitoring commitment

- Continue water-quality logging on the lease (salinity, temperature, dissolved oxygen).
- Maintain harvest and mortality records per existing reporting.
- Report any disease or biosecurity event to the consulting veterinarian and the agency per rule.

The applicant requests review and is available for a site visit at the agency's convenience.

DRAFT. Joint filing with D. Patterson. Hold for owner review; do not transmit to the agency without explicit approval.